

Syncing Templates to Client Projects

Agencia SaaS — Multi-tenant Payload CMS platform

Workflow to propagate changes from the `astro-starter` and `nextjs-starter` templates (in this monorepo) to the standalone client projects under `/home/joseba/Cientes/clientes/<slug>/`.

Why sync manually? Templates live in this monorepo, but each client is a separate project. The sync scripts propagate allowlisted template changes without overwriting client-specific work (styles, content, `.env`).

Procedure

1 Move to the backend directory.

```
cd /home/joseba/Cientes/agencia/agencia-backend
```

All sync scripts live here.

2 Dry-run, single client.

```
pnpm sync:client --slug=<slug> --verbose
```

The `--verbose` flag prints a line-by-line diff. Use this for the first pass on a representative client to see the actual content of the change.

3 Dry-run, all outdated clients.

```
pnpm sync:clients --filter=outdated
```

Skips clients that are already up to date. Output is a summary table with file counts per client.

4 Read the output.

- `updated` — there are pending changes.
- `skipped` — the client is already in sync.
- `errors` — something failed for that client (the batch continues; you must inspect).

5 Apply the changes.

```
# Single client
pnpm sync:client --slug=<slug> --apply

# All outdated clients
pnpm sync:clients --filter=outdated --apply
```

Every modified file is backed up as `<file>.bak-<unix-ts>` next to itself.

6 Remove the backups in each client.

```
cd /home/joseba/Clientes/clientes/<slug>
find . -name "*.bak-<timestamp>" -delete
```

Do this *before* committing the client, or add the pattern to the client's `.gitignore`.

7 Verify the client still builds and renders.

```
# Terminal 1: backend
cd /home/joseba/Clientes/agencia/agencia-backend
pnpm dev

# Terminal 2: client
cd /home/joseba/Clientes/clientes/<slug>
pnpm dev
```

Port 3000 conflict: Payload and Next.js both default to 3000. Next.js offers to switch to 3001 automatically, or set `PORT=3001` in the client `.env`.

8 Commit the client (if it has its own git repo).

```
cd /home/joseba/Clientes/clientes/<slug>
git status
git add <changed files>
git commit -m "chore: sync from <astro|nextjs> template"
```

Useful flags

Flag	Default	Purpose
<code>--apply</code>	<code>false</code>	Writes the changes. Without it, the command is a dry-run.
<code>--filter=outdated</code>	<code>all</code>	Skips clients that are already up to date (saves time on bulk operations).
<code>--template=astro nextjs</code>	auto-detect	Override the auto-detect from <code>package.json#name</code> when the client has been renamed.
<code>--verbose</code>	<code>false</code>	Line-by-line diff in dry-run (single-client only).

Allowlist and blocklist

The sync only touches files in the per-template allowlist (see `agencia-backend/scripts/sync-template.ts`). Everything else in the client is left alone.

- Astro allowlist:** `astro.config.mjs`, `tsconfig.json`, `src/lib/{payload,types,lexical}.ts`, `src/components/{BlockRenderer,Link,shared/SeoHead,HeroBlock,FooterBlock}.astro`, `src/layouts/Layout.astro`, `src/content/site.config.ts`, `src/pages/{[slug],index,404,preview}.astro`.

- **Next.js allowlist:** `next.config.ts` , `tsconfig.json` , `src/lib/{payload,types,lexical}.ts` , `src/components/{BlockRenderer,Link,shared/SeoHead,HeroBlock,FooterBlock}.{tsx,ts}` , `src/app/{layout,page,not-found}.tsx` , `src/app/[slug]/page.tsx` , `src/app/preview/page.tsx` , `src/content/site.config.ts` .
- **Blocklist (never touched):** `src/styles/*.css` , `src/components/blocks/*` , `src/components/**/styles.css` , `.env` , `node_modules/` , build outputs (`dist/` , `.next/` , `.astro/`), `public/` .

For `package.json` and dependency updates

The `update:client` and `update:clients` scripts follow the same pattern but operate on `package.json` and the lockfile. They back up `package.json` as `package.json.bak-<ts>` and run `pnpm install --no-frozen-lockfile` on apply. Use `--skip-install` to defer the install step.

Troubleshooting

"Hook timed out" in integration tests

PostgreSQL not running or saturated. Start the docker compose stack in `agencia-backend/` and re-run.

Schema migration prompt in tests

Payload detects a schema change against the dev DB and asks interactively. Either drop and recreate the dev DB (loses seeded data) or run `payload migrate:create` then `payload migrate` to keep the data.

Sync changes a file you did not expect

Run `pnpm sync:client --slug=<slug> --verbose` to see the exact diff. If a file should not be in the allowlist, edit `ALLOWLIST_ASTRO` or `ALLOWLIST_NEXTJS` in `agencia-backend/scripts/sync-template.ts` .